

Kitsune no Kami: The Gekiga Treatment

Adapting the NEKOnet Procedural Protocol for Kamakura-Era Storytelling



The Sequence of Violence



The Cheat:
A crowded gambling den. A ronin notices the dealer switching the dice.



The Ultimatum:
He draws Kitsune no Kami. A terrifying promise of death.



The Remnant:
One grubby gambler remains, asking for the end.



The Rupture: He stands to leave in disgust. Thugs grapple him. He breaks their grasp.



The Collapse: The psychological pressure breaks them. They scatter in mortal terror.

The Visual Paradigm: 1970s Seinen Architecture



Dry Brush Dominance

Friction, weather, age, and violence. Unpolished brushwork leaving the tool's drag visible to represent moral exhaustion.

Panel Geometry

Gutters behave like cuts, slashes, and impact fractures. Aggressively irregular diagonals slice the page into impact zones.

Tonal Extremes

A strict system of pure white silence, fine hatch atmosphere, kinetic dry-brush noise, and dense black pools. No digital rendering.

Establishing the Protocol

Modern Anime (Avoid)

Clean vector contours

Symmetrical superhero posing

Overcrowded backgrounds,
lush world-building

Melodramatic, cute expressions

Kamakura Gekiga Protocol (Target)



Broken contour lines, visible
paper grain, analog scan decay



Functional anatomy,
weight-bearing imbalance,
defensive instinct

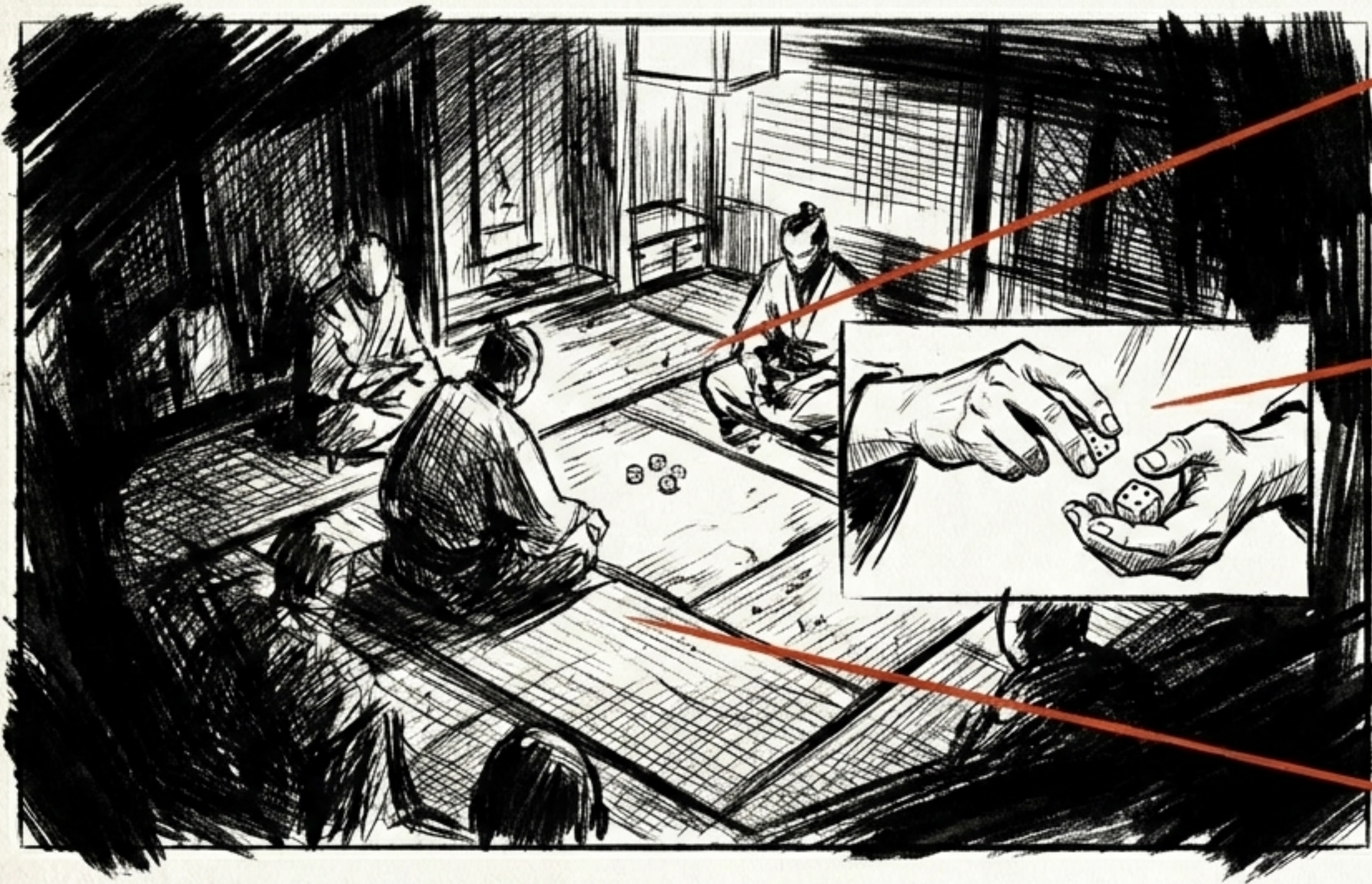


Severe landscapes, stark
negative space, psychological
pressure



Understated, tactical stillness,
violent without melodrama

Beat 1: The Setup & The Cheat



Tatami & Floor: Substitute sleek concrete with rough tatami and wood grain. Use fine hatching to show extreme age and wear.

The Dealer: Faces reduced to essential signals. The cheat is conveyed through a cropped, tight close-up of strained hands manipulating the dice, avoiding exaggerated faciated facial smirks.

The Shadows: Utilize dense black masses for the den's perimeter. Establish a fatalistic, breathless mood before the physical rupture.

Beat 2: The Rupture & Unsheathing



Physical Consequence:

The Ronin's strength is shown through off-balance, weight-bearing poses and heavy fabric stress lines. The thugs brace, fall, and lose control.

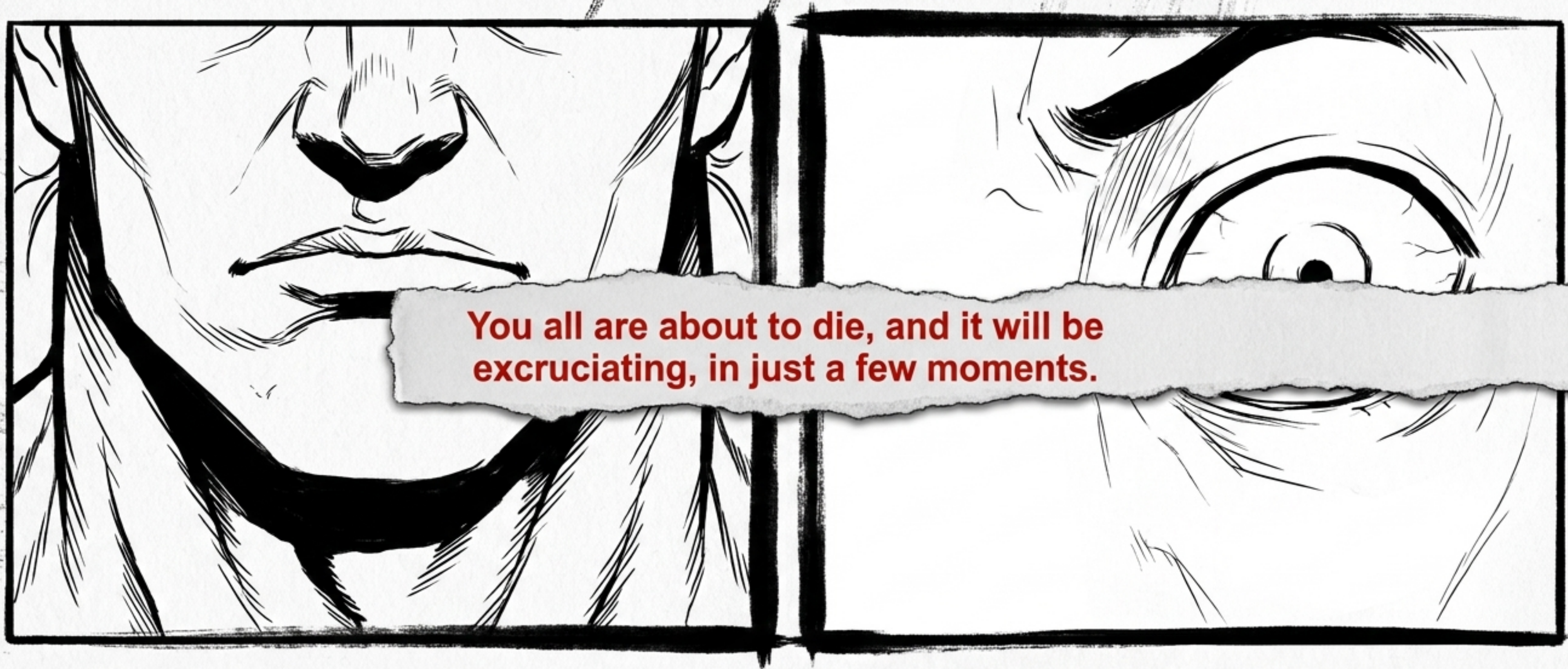
The Gutters:

The layout must feel struck. Long narrow inserts show only partial bodies. The page prioritizes kinetic simultaneity over linear clarity.

The Blade:

The katana (Kitsune no Kami) is unsheathed with sharper, frictionless lines, cutting cleanly through the rough, organic dry-brush noise.

Beat 3: The ultimatum

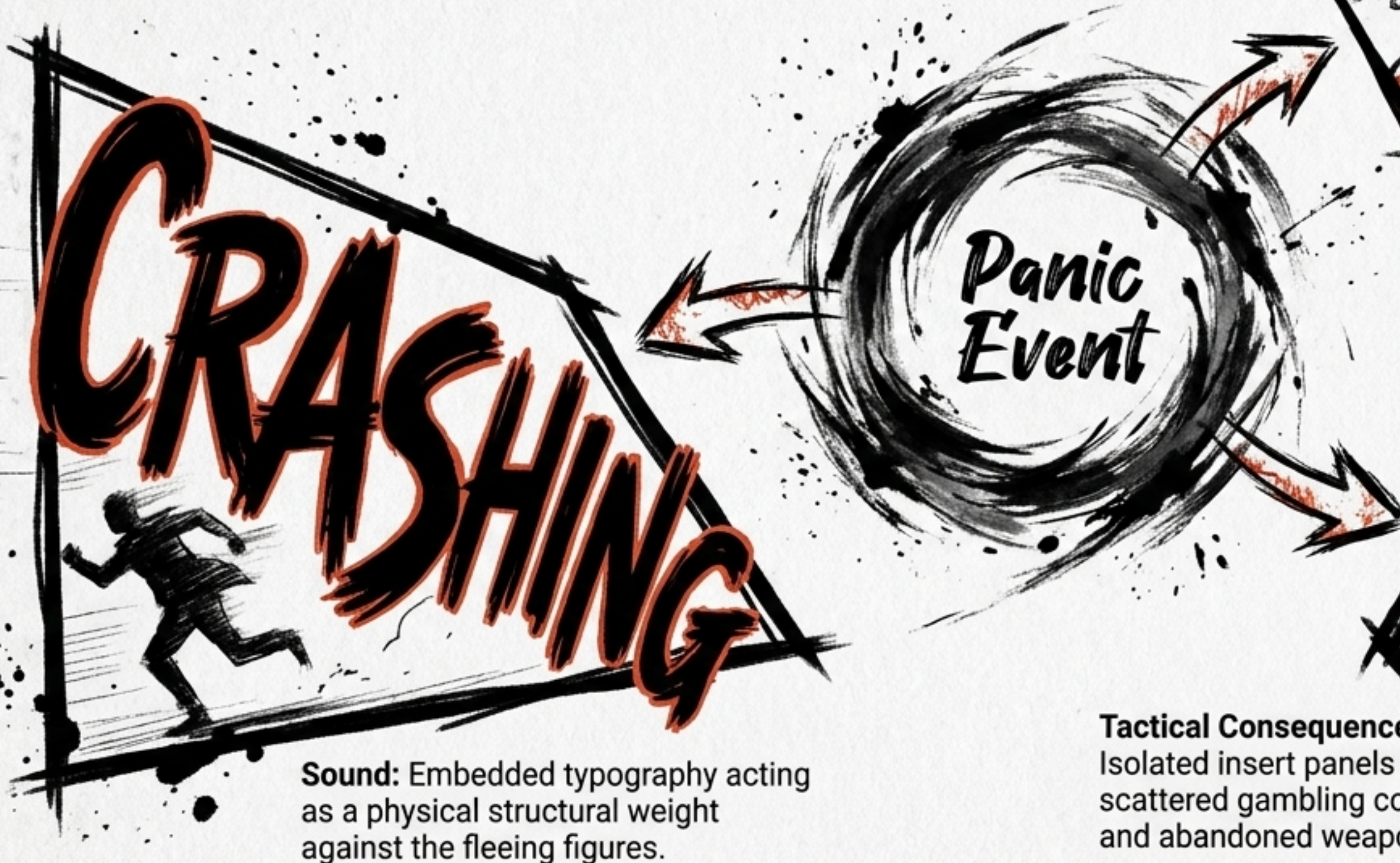


The Threat: Heavy contour, thick neck musculature.
Deep black shadows under the jaw.
Emotional register: Procedural, intelligent, unsparing.

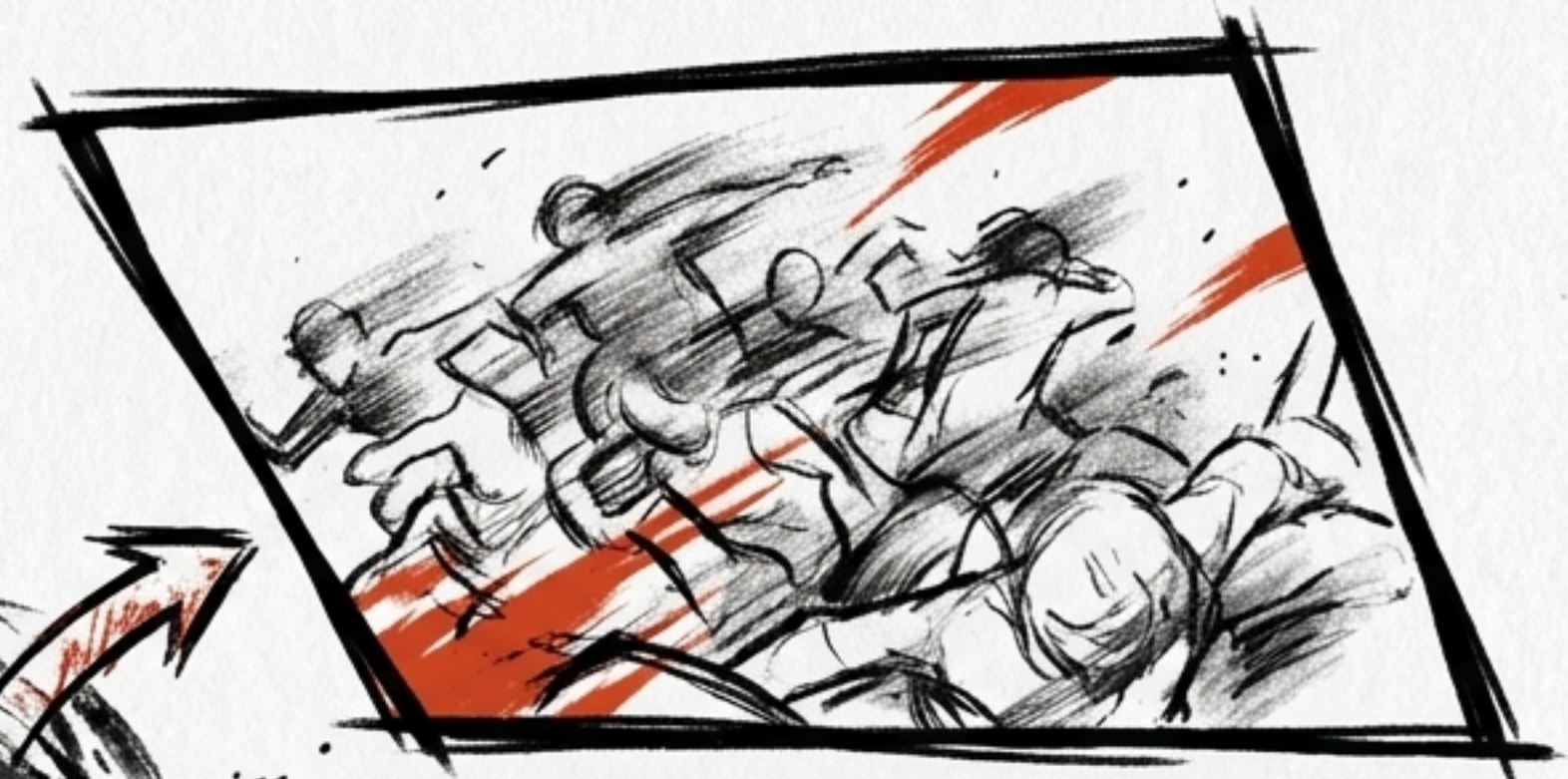
The Prey: Sparse line weight. Pure white negative space pressing in to create psychological pressure.
Cropped expressions of mortal shock.

Beat 4: Time Compression & Collapse

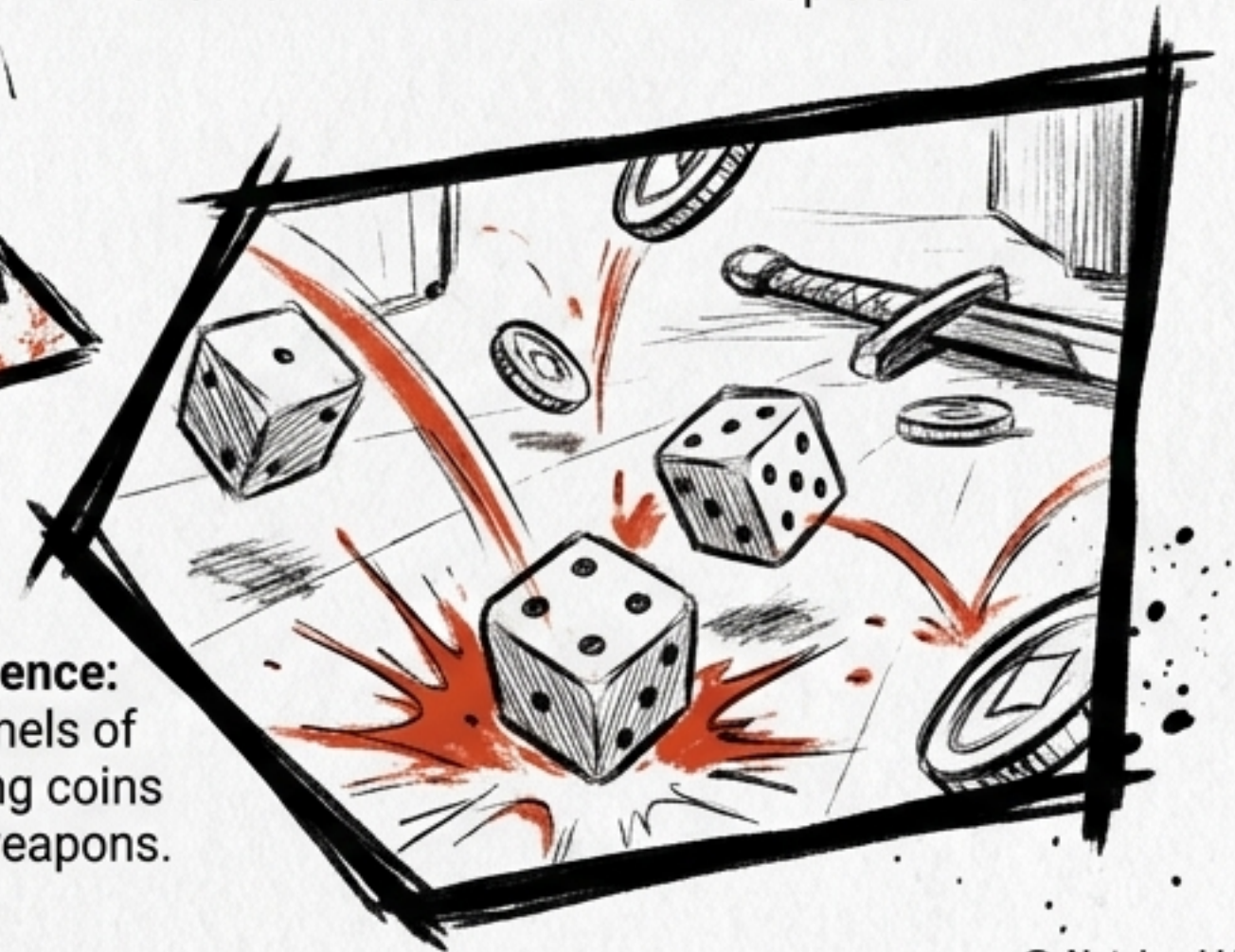
The page behaves like a fragmented memory field parsing multiple signals at once.



Sound: Embedded typography acting as a physical structural weight against the fleeing figures.



Physical Action: Chaotic kinetic mass of fleeing bodies, rendered with aggressive dry-brush streaks for dust and sudden displacement.



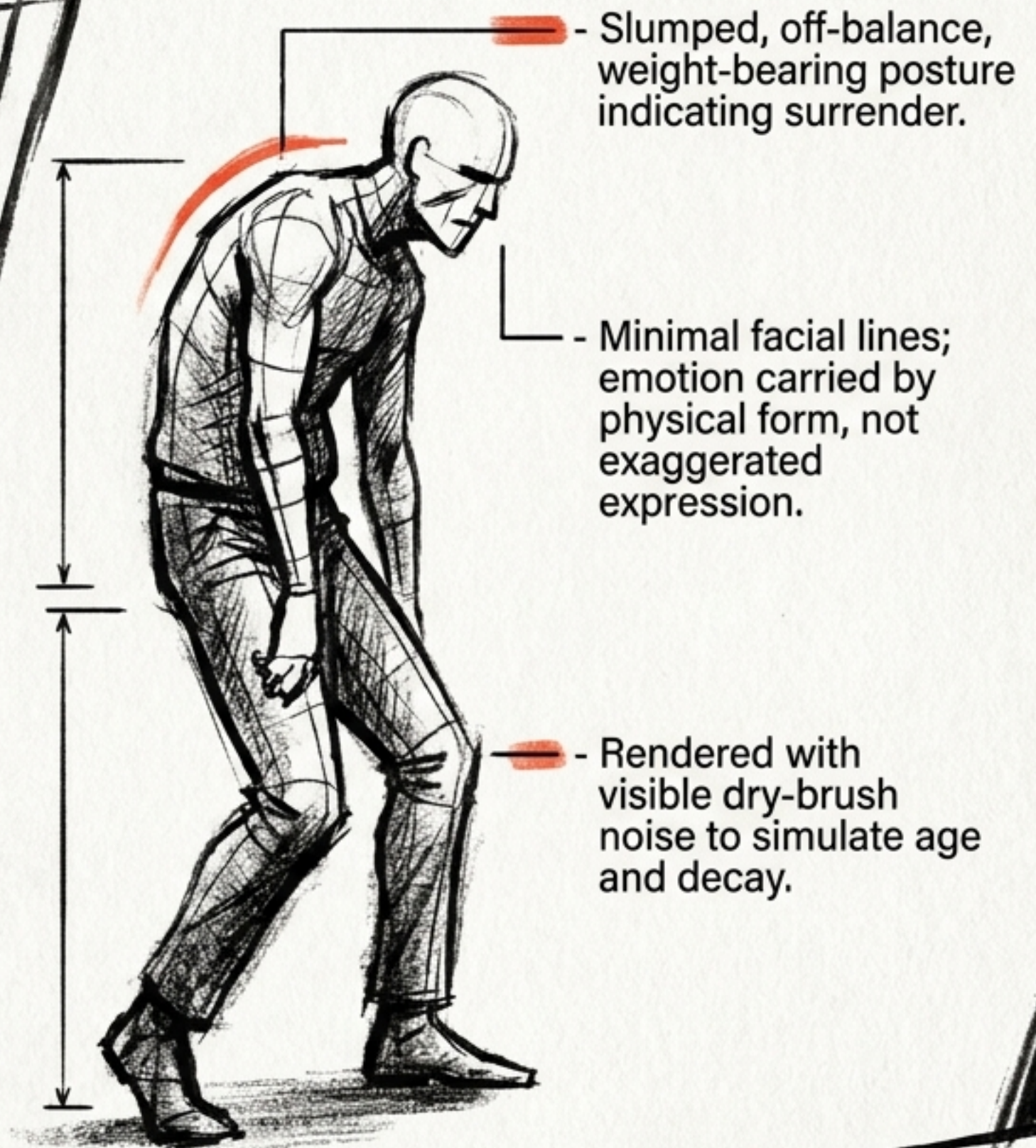
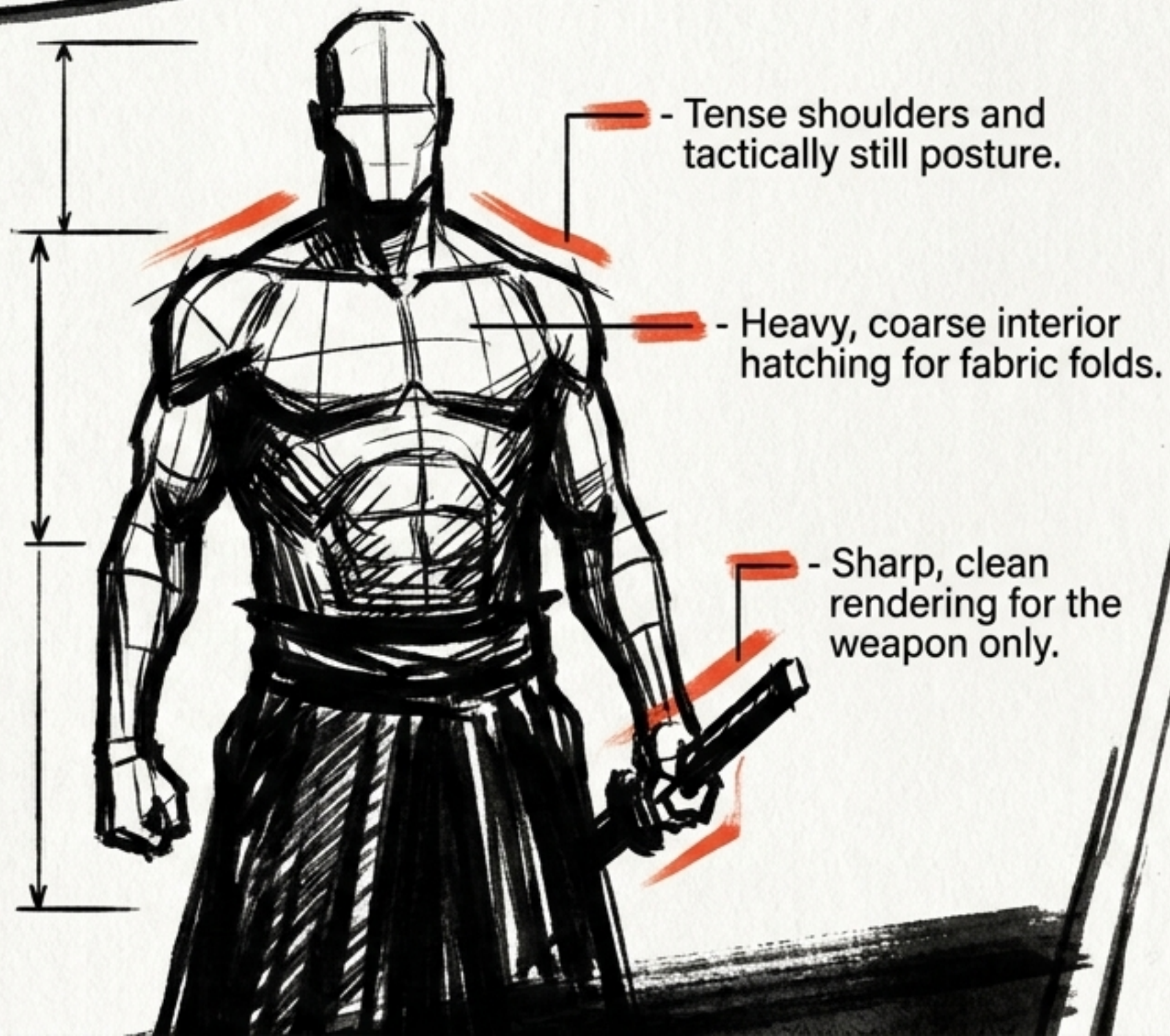
Tactical Consequence: Isolated insert panels of scattered gambling coins and abandoned weapons.

Beat 5: The Remnant

The return to emptiness. The environment is reduced to pure white silence and deep black pools of shadow. The figure is small, grounded by heavy ink drag to symbolize total moral and physical exhaustion. Violence gives way to old-world austerity.



Anatomy of a Scene: Character Constraints



The Kamakura SFX Palette

Sound effects are not floating labels. They act as physical forces inside the composition, drawn with uneven scale and abrupt positioning.



The clean, frictionless slide of Kitsune no Kami leaving the scabbard.
Sharp, diagonal placement.

The splintering of wood and clatter of dice during the physical rupture.
Heavy, blocky, embedded in the floor texture.

The absence of sound during the final standoff, represented by vast, un-inked negative space.

Modular Seed Architecture

Block 1: The Base Gekiga Style

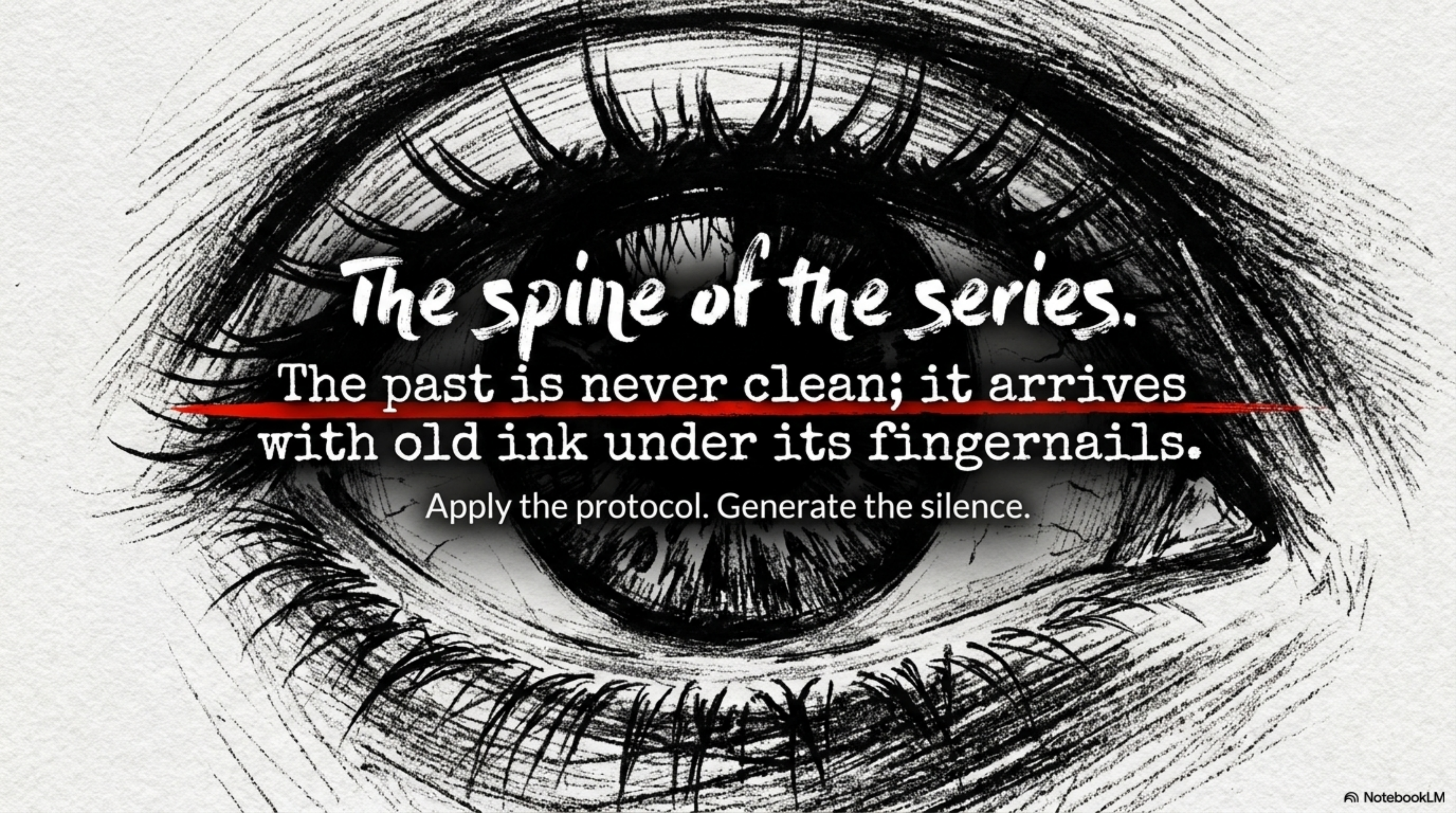
Black-and-white adult seinen gekiga manga page, 1970s brushwork tradition. Irregular diagonal panels, dry-brush ink, rough paper grain, heavy black shadows, extreme negative space, analog scan texture.

Block 2: The Kamakura Adaptation

A Kamakura-era ronin in a tense gambling den. Focus on tatami, wood grain, sparse environmental details. Render figures with functional anatomy, tense hands, off-balance movement, and fatalistic stillness. No glossy digital rendering.

Block 3: The Scene Injection (Beat 2 Example)

Fragmented cinematic action. The ronin breaks a grapple, unsheathing a katana. Narrow inserts of fleeing bodies and scattered dice. Sparse hand-drawn SFX embedded as physical objects: KRRK, ZWHIP.



The spine of the series.

The past is never clean; it arrives
with old ink under its fingernails.

Apply the protocol. Generate the silence.